

Absolutely — **sunny** is useful, though its core lexical range is fairly compact. The main meanings are **full of sunshine**, **bright/cheerful in mood or appearance**, and a few figurative extensions such as **sunny disposition** and **sunny outlook**.

Word family: **sun / sunny / sunnier / sunniest / sunshine / sunlight / sunlit**

Base noun: sun

Adjective: sunny

Comparative: sunnier

Superlative: sunniest

Related forms: sunshine, sunlight, sunlit

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun family (名詞詞族)

Your sentence:

> “...some smaller ones are kept on a **sunny balcony** just outside her kitchen.”

Meaning in your passage: **sunny** = receiving a lot of sunlight — 陽光充足的；向陽的

Here **sunny** means:

> **a place that gets plenty of direct sunlight.**

繁體中文：

能照到很多陽光、光照充足的；向陽的

Natural translation:

> “a sunny balcony”

「一個**陽光充足的露台 / 向陽露台**」

So here:

> **sunny** = 光照充足、經常有陽光照射的

1. **sunny** = full of sunshine (天氣) — 陽光充足的；晴朗的

The core weather meaning.

Practice 1

> “It was a warm, ****sunny**** day.”

「那是一個溫暖而****晴朗、陽光充足的日子****。」

Practice 2

> “The weather should stay sunny tomorrow.”

「明天天氣應該會保持****晴朗****。」

****sunny — weather = 有充足陽光、雲量較少的****

2. ****sunny = receiving lots of sunlight (地方) — 向陽的 ; 陽光充足的****

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 3 — Original

> “The smaller plants are kept on a ****sunny balcony****.”

「較小的植物放在一個****陽光充足的露台****上。」

Practice 4

> “Tomatoes grow well in a sunny spot.”

「番茄在****向陽的位置****生長得很好。」

Practice 5

> “Put the pot near a sunny window.”

「把花盆放在****陽光充足的窗邊****。」

****sunny — place = 某個位置能長時間 / 經常接受日照****

3. ****sunny = bright and cheerful (外觀 / 氣氛) — 明亮愉快的 ; 充滿朝氣的****

A common figurative extension.

Practice 6

> “The room has a **sunny** atmosphere.”

「這個房間有一種**明亮愉快的氣氛**。」

Practice 7

> “She chose sunny colours for the kitchen.”

「她替廚房選了**明亮活潑的色彩**。」

sunny — appearance/mood = 讓人聯想到陽光般明亮、溫暖、愉快的

4. **sunny** = cheerful / optimistic in personality (性格) — 開朗的 ; 樂觀的

A strong figurative meaning.

Practice 8

> “She has a **sunny personality**.”

「她性格很**開朗樂觀**。」

Practice 9

> “His sunny nature makes people feel comfortable.”

「他**開朗隨和的性格**讓人感到自在。」

sunny — personality = 性格樂觀、開朗、容易帶給別人愉快感覺的

5. **sunny** = optimistic / positive in outlook (態度) — 樂觀的 ; 正面的

Practice 10

> “She has a **sunny outlook** on life.”

「她對人生抱持**樂觀正面的態度**。」

Practice 11

> “The report presents a rather sunny view of the future.”

「這份報告對未來抱持相當**樂觀的看法**。」

****sunny — outlook/view = 對未來或情況採取積極、樂觀的看法****

6. ****sun = star at the centre of our solar system — 太陽****

The core family noun.

Practice 12

> “The ****sun**** is shining.”

「****太陽****正在照耀。」

Practice 13

> “Plants need light from the sun.”

「植物需要****陽光 / 太陽光****。」

****sun = 太陽系中心的恆星****

7. ****sun = sunlight / direct sunshine (陽光) — 日光 ; 陽光****

A common everyday noun extension.

Practice 14

> “This plant needs plenty of ****sun****.”

「這種植物需要充足的****陽光****。」

Practice 15

> “The balcony gets a lot of sun in the afternoon.”

「露台下午有很多****日照****。」

****sun = 陽光 / 日照，而不是太陽本身****

Very common in gardening.

8. **sunshine = sunlight (陽光) — 陽光 ; 日照**

Practice 16

> “The flowers need several hours of **sunshine**.”

「這些花每天需要幾個小時的**陽光**。」

Practice 17

> “We sat outside in the sunshine.”

「我們坐在外面享受**陽光**。」

sunshine = 太陽照射下來的光與溫暖

9. **sunshine = happiness / cheerfulness (比喻) — 快樂 ; 溫暖感**

A common figurative noun use.

Practice 18

> “Her smile brought a little **sunshine** into the room.”

「她的笑容為房間帶來一點**溫暖和歡樂**。」

Practice 19

> “The children were a source of sunshine in his life.”

「孩子們是他生活中的**快樂與溫暖來源**。」

sunshine — figurative = 令人感到快樂、溫暖、希望的東西

10. **sunlight = light from the sun — 太陽光 ; 日光**

Practice 20

> “The leaves need direct **sunlight**.”

「葉子需要直接的**日光**。」

Practice 21

> “Too much sunlight can damage some plants.”

「過多**陽光**可能會傷害某些植物。」

sunlight = 太陽發出的光線

Compared with **sunshine**, **sunlight** is more neutral/physical.

11. **sunlit = lit by sunlight — 被陽光照亮的；向陽的**

Practice 22

> “They sat in a **sunlit** room.”

「他們坐在一個**陽光照亮的房間**裡。」

Practice 23

> “The plants were placed on a sunlit shelf.”

「植物被放在一個**有陽光照射的架子**上。」

sunlit = 被自然陽光照亮的

12. **sunny side (較少見一般用法) — 向陽的一面；陽光較多的一側**

Practice 24

> “The herbs grow better on the **sunny side** of the balcony.”

「香草在露台**向陽的一邊**長得較好。」

Practice 25

> “Choose the sunny side of the garden.”

「選花園**日照較充足的一側**。」

****sunny side = 比另一側得到更多陽光的一面****

Important distinction: ****sunny vs bright****

****sunny****

= specifically associated with sunshine, or figuratively cheerful.

****bright****

= high in light intensity / vivid / intelligent depending on context.

> sunny room

> = 陽光充足的房間

> bright room

> = 明亮的房間

A room can be bright because of lamps but not sunny.

Important distinction: ****sunny vs clear****

****sunny****

= lots of sunshine.

****clear****

= little/no cloud, fog, etc.

A day can be:

* clear and sunny;

* clear but not especially sunny at certain times;

* sunny with some clouds.

Not identical.

Important distinction: ****sunny vs warm****

sunny

describes sunlight.

warm

describes temperature.

A sunny winter day can still be cold.

So:

> sunny ≠ warm

Important distinction: **sunny vs cheerful**

sunny

figuratively = naturally bright/positive.

cheerful

= noticeably happy and positive in mood.

> sunny personality

> = 開朗樂觀的性格

> cheerful person

> = 心情愉快、表現開朗的人

They overlap strongly, but **sunny** is more metaphorical.

Important distinction: **sunny vs optimistic**

sunny

can describe a warm, bright personality or outlook.

optimistic

specifically means expecting good outcomes.

So:

> sunny disposition

> = 開朗性格

> optimistic forecast

> = 樂觀預測

Important distinction: **sun vs sunlight vs sunshine**

sun

can mean:

* the star;

* everyday “sun exposure.”

sunlight

= physical light from the sun.

sunshine

= sunlight, often with a warmer/more pleasant emotional tone.

For gardening:

> needs full sun

> = 需要充足日照

> needs direct sunlight

> = 需要直射陽光

Both are natural.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **sunny — weather** = 晴朗 / 陽光充足

* **sunny — place** = 向陽 / 日照充足

* **sunny — atmosphere/appearance** = 明亮愉快

* **sunny — personality** = 開朗樂觀
 * **sunny — outlook** = 樂觀正面
 * **sun — star** = 太陽
 * **sun — sunlight exposure** = 日照 / 陽光
 * **sunshine — literal** = 陽光
 * **sunshine — figurative** = 快樂 / 溫暖感
 * **sunlight** = 太陽光
 * **sunlit** = 被陽光照亮的
 * **sunny side** = 向陽的一側

This is a relatively compact family, so I would stop there rather than force rare idioms or obscure technical uses.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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sunny — weather	有充足陽光、雲量較少的；晴朗的
sunny — place	某位置能經常 / 長時間接受陽光照射的
sunny — atmosphere/appearance	令人聯想到陽光般明亮、溫暖、愉快的
sunny — personality	性格開朗、樂觀，容易帶給別人愉快感覺的
sunny — outlook	對未來 / 情況採取積極、樂觀的看法
sun — star	太陽系中心的恆星
sun — exposure	日照 / 陽光
sunshine — literal	太陽照射下來的光與溫暖
sunshine — figurative	令人感到快樂、溫暖或希望的東西
sunlight	太陽發出的光線
sunlit	被自然陽光照亮的
sunny side	比另一側接受更多陽光的一面

For your original sentence

> “...some smaller ones are kept on a **sunny balcony** just outside her kitchen.”

The exact meaning is:

sunny = 那個露台能接收到充足日照，適合植物生長

So naturally:

> **「一些較小的植物則放在廚房外一個陽光充足的露台上。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****sunny day**** → 晴朗的一天
- > ****sunny balcony**** → 向陽 / 日照充足的露台
- > ****sunny personality**** → 開朗樂觀的性格
- > ****sunny outlook**** → 樂觀的看法
- > ****sunlight**** → 日光
- > ****sunshine**** → 陽光 / 比喻快樂與溫暖